

Healthcare Administration English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: hospital administrators, clinic managers, practice administrators, care coordinators, patient-experience leaders, revenue-cycle staff, operations managers, and healthcare-adjacent professionals

Focus: A challenging professional English curriculum for healthcare administration teams who need precise language for access, patient flow, revenue cycle, quality, compliance, staffing, service recovery, care coordination, and executive reporting.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Patient Access, Scheduling, and Referrals

Situation

A clinic is losing referrals because patients wait too long for first appointments.

Stakeholder pressure: Open more appointment slots immediately.

Constraint: Provider capacity, eligibility checks, referral completeness, and no-show risk are unclear.

Terms to use

- referral
- eligibility
- authorization
- no-show

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A clinic is losing referrals because patients wait too long for first appointments.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Open more appointment slots immediately.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm referral, eligibility, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	access improvement memo
B	evidence
C	risk
D	owner

Module 2. Revenue Cycle, Coding, and Denials

Situation

Denials have increased after a payer policy change.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell billing to fix the claims faster.

Constraint: The root cause may involve documentation, coding, authorization, or payer rules.

Terms to use

- claim
- coding
- denial
- clean claim

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

Denials have increased after a payer policy change.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell billing to fix the claims faster.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm claim, coding, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	denial root-cause brief
B	board-ready operations update
C	evidence
D	risk

Module 3. Patient Flow, Capacity, and Staffing**Situation**

Emergency department boarding is delaying inpatient admissions.

Stakeholder pressure: Move patients upstairs faster.

Constraint: Bed availability, discharge timing, acuity, transport, and nursing coverage all interact.

Terms to use

- census
- bed management
- throughput

- staffing ratio

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Emergency department boarding is delaying inpatient admissions.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Move patients upstairs faster.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm census, bed management, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	capacity escalation update
B	timeline
C	assumption
D	mitigation

Module 4. Quality, Safety, and Accreditation

Situation

A wrong-patient near miss occurred during registration.

Stakeholder pressure: Treat it as a training issue and move on.

Constraint: Patient safety, process reliability, and documentation require a structured review.

Terms to use

- near miss
- accreditation
- audit trail
- corrective action

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A wrong-patient near miss occurred during registration.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Treat it as a training issue and move on.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm near miss, accreditation, the owner, and the evidence standard.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	owner
B	quality event summary
C	evidence
D	risk

Module 5. HIPAA, Privacy, and Information Governance

Situation

A manager wants patient lists emailed to a vendor for outreach.

Stakeholder pressure: Send the spreadsheet today.

Constraint: Minimum necessary use, vendor agreements, and secure transmission must be confirmed.

Terms to use

- HIPAA
- protected health information
- minimum necessary
- business associate

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A manager wants patient lists emailed to a vendor for outreach.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Send the spreadsheet today.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm HIPAA, protected health information, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	quality event summary
B	service recovery script
C	care coordination plan

Option	Phrase
D	privacy-safe vendor response

Module 6. Patient Experience and Service Recovery

Situation

A family complains about poor communication during discharge.

Stakeholder pressure: Apologize and promise it will never happen again.

Constraint: The organization needs empathy, review, realistic commitment, and documented follow-up.

Terms to use

- grievance
- service recovery
- HCAHPS
- patient experience

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A family complains about poor communication during discharge.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Apologize and promise it will never happen again.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm grievance, service recovery, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	control
B	disclosure
C	access improvement memo
D	service recovery script

Module 7. Population Health and Care Coordination

Situation

A payer flags high readmissions for heart-failure patients.

Stakeholder pressure: Call every patient and tell them to comply.

Constraint: Social needs, discharge instructions, medication access, and follow-up timing affect outcomes.

Terms to use

- care gap
- readmission
- discharge planning
- social determinants

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A payer flags high readmissions for heart-failure patients.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Call every patient and tell them to comply.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm care gap, readmission, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	timeline
B	care coordination plan
C	owner
D	scope

Module 8. Executive Dashboards and Board Updates**Situation**

The board asks why wait times improved but patient satisfaction fell.

Stakeholder pressure: Show more charts.

Constraint: Metrics need interpretation, tradeoffs, assumptions, and action owners.

Terms to use

- dashboard
- KPI
- variance
- owner

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

The board asks why wait times improved but patient satisfaction fell.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Show more charts.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm dashboard, KPI, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	control
B	board-ready operations update
C	mitigation
D	approval

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

Patient Access, Scheduling, and Referrals

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. access improvement memo	A access improvement memo is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Revenue Cycle, Coding, and Denials

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. denial root-cause brief	A denial root-cause brief is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Patient Flow, Capacity, and Staffing

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. capacity escalation update	A capacity escalation update is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Quality, Safety, and Accreditation

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. quality event summary	A quality event summary is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

HIPAA, Privacy, and Information Governance

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. privacy-safe vendor response	A privacy-safe vendor response is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Patient Experience and Service Recovery

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. service recovery script	A service recovery script is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Population Health and Care Coordination

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. care coordination plan	A care coordination plan is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Executive Dashboards and Board Updates

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. board-ready operations update	A board-ready operations update is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.